

Provenge (sipuleucel-T)

Original Effective Date: 9/1/2020

Revision Date(s): 9/2020; 10/2021; 10/2022; 10/2023; 6/10/2024; 10/1/2025

Review Date: 10/1/2025

Policy type: Medical Necessity

Line of Business: All GEHA Medical Plans

Authorizations are for three doses per lifetime.

Indication Specific Criteria:

Prostate Cancer, Metastatic

- Member is 18 years of age or older, **AND**
- Member's prostate cancer is castrate resistant (hormone refractory), **AND**
- Member is asymptomatic or minimally symptomatic, **AND**
- Member has an Eastern Cooperative Oncology Group (ECOG) of 0-1¹, **AND**
- Member has a life expectancy of at least six months, **AND**
- Member does not have hepatic or other visceral metastases, **AND**
- Provenge is used as a single agent²

Universal Approval Criteria:

Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:

- National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2A level of evidence; **OR**
- United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with the product labeling; **OR**
- Indications not included in the official FDA labeling or recommended by NCCN (Category 1 or 2A level of evidence) may be considered if determined to be medically necessary per one or more of the following compendia:
 - Clinical Pharmacology (Strong For); **OR**
 - Wolters Kluwer Lexi-Drugs® (Level A); **OR**
- Other uses of drugs and biologics may be considered medically necessary if supported as safe and effective according to peer-reviewed articles from one of the following journals:
 - American Journal of Medicine; Annals of Internal Medicine; Annals of Oncology; Annals of Surgical Oncology; Biology of Blood and Marrow Transplantation; Blood; Bone Marrow Transplantation; British Journal of Cancer; British Journal of Hematology; British Medical

¹ ECOG score of greater than 1 will be considered on a case-by-case basis

² Members may continue androgen deprivation therapy (ADT) to maintain castrate levels of serum testosterone (<50 ng/dL).

Journal; Cancer; Clinical Cancer Research; Drugs; European Journal of Cancer (formerly the European Journal of Cancer and Clinical Oncology); Gynecologic Oncology; International Journal of Radiation, Oncology, Biology, and Physics; The Journal of the American Medical Association, Journal of Clinical Oncology; Journal of the National Cancer Institute; Journal of the National Comprehensive Cancer Network (NCCN); Journal of Urology; Lancet; Lancet Oncology; Leukemia; The New England Journal of Medicine; Radiation Oncology;

- **Meeting abstracts and case reports are excluded from consideration;**
- Non-standard protocols may be approved based on unique clinical circumstances;
- Dose and frequency should be consistent with United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling, National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN), or indication specific peer-reviewed literature;
- In the instance that a request is made for drug(s) that was (were) previously tried (including in the same pharmacologic class or with the same mechanism of action) and such drug(s) was (were) discontinued due to a lack of efficacy the request may be subject to an off-label review for medical necessity unless supported by the NCCN or high quality literature (prospective phase 2 or 3 studies published as full manuscripts in a CMS-supported journal).

Billing

Drug Name	HCPCS Code	Description
Provenge	Q2043	Sipuleucel-t, minimum of 50 million autologous cd54+ cells activated with pap-gm-csf, including leukapheresis and all other preparatory procedures, per infusion

References

1. Provenge [package insert]. Dendreon Pharmaceuticals LLC, Seal Beach, CA. Available at: https://provenge.com/hcp/wp-content/uploads/sites/3/2023/07/Provenge_Prescribing_Information.pdf
2. Provenge. National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN). NCCN Drugs & Biologics Compendium. Available at: https://www.nccn.org/professionals/drug_compendium/content/.
3. Referenced with permission from the NCCN Clinical Practice Guidelines in Oncology (NCCN Guidelines®). National Comprehensive Cancer Network, Inc. 2025. All rights reserved. Accessed September 12, 2025. To view the most recent and complete version of the guideline, go online to NCCN.org.
4. Kantoff PW, Higano CS, Shore ND, Berger ER, Small EJ, Penson DF, Redfern CH, Ferrari AC, Dreicer R, Sims RB, Xu Y, Frohlich MW, Schellhammer PF; IMPACT Study Investigators. Sipuleucel-T immunotherapy for castration-resistant prostate cancer. N Engl J Med. 2010 Jul 29;363(5):411-22. doi: 10.1056/NEJMoa1001294. PMID: 20818862.

Disclaimer

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Date	Updates
11/2023	Policy updated to new format. No changes to criteria.
6/10/2024	Annual Review; approved by P&T
10/1/2025	Annual Review, OH P&T approved; updated template
10/23/25	Policy adopted by GEHA; document updated for universal accessibility.